

— POETRY & QUOTES

Dance Anyway

*On Permission, Audiences,
and the Things We Almost Delete*

BREATH OF POETRY · 2026

@mistakenlyhuman

— SLIDE 1 OF 7

The Quote Has a *Dark Sequel*

- 'Dance like nobody's watching' — you've heard it
- Here's what nobody adds: eventually, people watch
- And then the watching changes everything

— SLIDE 2 OF 7

The 6-Second *Video*

- 11pm, alone, doing something embarrassing
- Almost deleted it before anyone saw
- It became the most authentic thing I'd ever posted

— SLIDE 3 OF 7

What the Best Pieces *Have in Common*

- Mid-thought, not fully formed
- Almost didn't post
- No framework — just honest

— SLIDE 4 OF 7

Unselfconsciousness

- The hardest creative skill
- Not about talent — about forgetting to care
- Our brains are engineered to monitor ourselves

— SLIDE 5 OF 7

The *Paradox*

- Authentic act → audience → mirror → self-consciousness
- Suddenly the dance is choreographed
- It wasn't supposed to be

— SLIDE 6 OF 7

The Small *Practice*

- One thing per week with no audience
- Not a draft, not a future post
- Keeps your center of gravity low

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Dance *Anyway*

- The room won't clear
- Applause doesn't arrive in advance
- Self-consciousness only disappears inside the doing

*The only way back to unselfconsciousness
is through — not around.*